THE DAILY SPORTS DEV 101

Day 3: Writing Sports Articles

DAY 2 HOMEWORK: READ A DAILY STORY

We will go around and share the stories you read. When it's your turn, answer these 3 things:

1) **What article did you read?**

2) **What did you like about the article?**

3) **What other thoughts did you have about the article?**

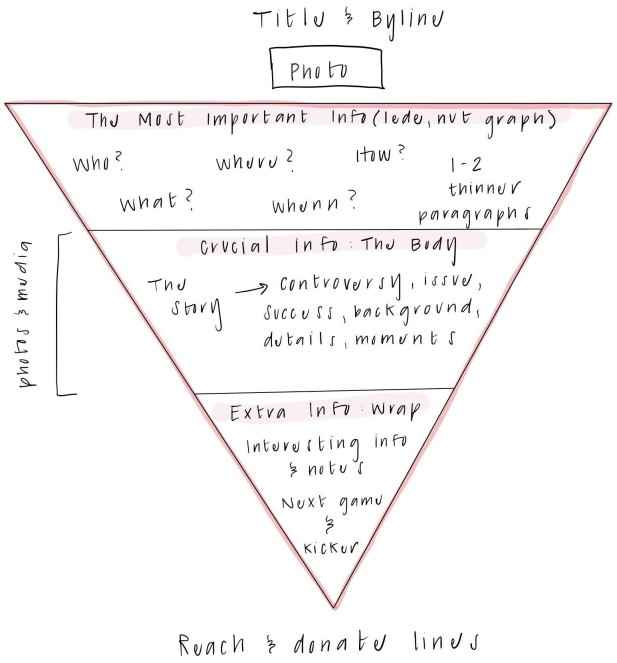
   Was anything unclear about the piece?

THE WRITING PROCESS

WRITING A STORY

You will write many different kinds of recaps for The Daily Sports. The majority will have this structure:

- **Lede**
- **Nut graph**
- **Body**
- **Wrap**
- **Reach Line**



LEDE

The lede is what gets the reader's attention, and makes them want to read the story.

Types of ledes:

1) **Hard lede**

The Washington football team seemed to beat itself Saturday night, falling 20-17 to Colorado to end the road season.

2) **Soft lede**

Following their first 0-2 start to a season in 13 years, maybe all the Huskies needed was a little bit of rain.

3) **Anecdotal lede**

Fist pumps from Dylan Morris. Shouts from Zion Tupuola-Fetui. Bows from Jalen McMillan.

4) **Zinger lede**

For 48 minutes, the Washington football team looked unstoppable.

NUT GRAPH

The nut graph is 1-2 paragraphs that summarize the main points of the story

Who, what, where, when, how

Sports: Washington, won/lost, opponent, score, place, time, why they won/lost

> Junior guard Sayvia Sellers led the way with 23 points while sophomore guard Avery Howell added six points with 10 defensive rebounds, as Washington shut down Minnesota with a stout defensive performance to earn a 67-54 win on Sunday afternoon.

*****If someone can read just your nut graph and get the gist of the game, it's a good nut graph!*****

BODY

The body is the meat of the story. It contains the rest of the information not explored in the nut graph

- **Quotes**
- **More about what made a team so good/bad**
- **Starts, runs, key moments, stats**

Context: Sellers non-factor

Quote from Avery Howell

Key stats: 1) Holding Michigan to 3-14

2) Huskies poor shooting

And most impressive of all, it was done almost entirely without the Huskies brightest star. Junior guard Sayvia Sellers played just six minutes in the first half after two early fouls. Although she would finish with 11 points, the Huskies were forced to look for scoring outside of their reliable point guard.

"We had everybody stepping up where we needed them to," Howell said. "We had everyone doing their part no matter what that was and then had people hitting big free throws and big shots. We knew this wasn't going to be on one person, we knew it was going to be a team win."

Thursday afternoon marked another departure from Langley's trademarked three-point offense. The Huskies hit just five shots from distance, and once again relied on their defense to carry them. UW held Michigan to a 3-for-14 mark from three and a 20-for-60 clip from the field.

BODY - Quotes

If it's a home game, we like quotes from 2-3 sources

Quotes should add to a story, not just bump the word count

Good quote examples:

"You can't win everything," McGrew said. "You can't win every year."

"Our coaches preach to embrace the big moments, stay calm, and don't really overthink it. " Weiss said. "That's kind of what I take into those moments. It's just another at-bat, it's just another pitch."

Not as good quote examples:

"Jayda Noble has had tremendous growth, and she just did a great job today [with] a couple [of] charges, and really [ran] our offense well," Langley said.

"I think we've learned what we have to do and now we just have to do it," Hopkins said. "We have to be more consistent for longer periods of time in those areas and that will give us chances to put ourselves in positions to win a lot of games."

WRAP

The wrap "wraps up a story"

- Final thoughts
- Interesting information/notes
- Kicker
- Transition to next game

But Michigan would eventually run out of gas, allowing Washington to end the game on a 7-0 run, picking up one of Langley's biggest career wins after tough losses on the road to USC and Stanford earlier in the season.

"I think this is just the natural progression from the couple of losses we had on the road," Langley said. "We were close and we had to grow in some of those areas down the stretch and you can see us continuing to grow."

Washington battles another ranked team from the Mitten State on Thursday, Jan. 8 at 6 p.m. when UW plays host to No. 24 Michigan State. The game will be streamed on Big Ten Plus.

Final thoughts

Kicker

Next game

REACH LINE

Ask our kind-hearted patrons (parents, alumni, old people) to support us

*Reach Sports Editor Andrew Sousa at **sports@dailyuw.com**. X: **@andrew_soozay**. Bluesky: **@andrew-soozay**.*

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Email is ALWAYS sports@dailyuw.com

We will make X and BlueSky accounts later

USING AI IN WRITING

OK

Otter.ai

grammarly

NOT OK

Anything else

If you are found using AI to write your stories, disciplinary policies include:

- Meetings with us, EIC, Managing
- Removal from a beat
- Suspension
- Termination

Your year in poetry

You wrestled with code and with stats,
SQL joins, R loops, and math chats;
When queries went wrong,
you debugged all along—
turning stumbles to structured formats.

If we see 100 m-dashes, usually a pretty good sign of AI!

HOMEWORK

Read a sports recap from [The Daily Sports]

As you're reading, try to identify each of the parts:

- **Lede**
- **Nut graph**
- **Body**
- **Wrap**
- **Reach Line**

Thursday, January 28: AP Style